

— NEURODIVERSITY · ADHD ARM
CLIENT & FAMILY INFORMATION

What to expect from an adult ADHD assessment

A guide to how assessment works with us — what happens at each stage, what the process feels like, and what you will leave with.

IN SHORT — WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

The steps

- 1 Book Stage One and complete the intake forms and screening questionnaires.
- 2 Receive your brief written screening memo with a recommendation.
- 3 Decide whether to continue to Stage Two — the full diagnostic assessment.
- 4 Attend the clinical interview, then a feedback consultation and written report.

Decisions that are yours

- Whether to begin with Stage One screening.
- Whether to proceed to Stage Two after reading your memo.
- Whether to include collateral information from a parent, partner or old school reports.
- Who you share the final report with — your GP or other health professionals.

Stage One \$500

Stage Two \$1,600

Both stages \$2,100

01 Why does a proper assessment involve more than a questionnaire?

An online quiz can indicate that certain experiences resonate with you. It cannot determine *why* they are occurring, establish whether they meet the diagnostic criteria for ADHD, or adequately consider other conditions and circumstances that can look similar.

A careful assessment answers a more useful question than simply, “Do I have ADHD?” It asks:

What is going on, how is it affecting my life, and what is likely to help?

We assess ADHD against internationally recognised diagnostic criteria (DSM-5-TR). However, the diagnostic outcome is only one part of the process. The broader aim is to develop an accurate, useful understanding of how you function across daily life.

02 How does the assessment process work?

The assessment is completed in two stages. This stepped approach allows us to undertake initial screening before you decide whether to proceed with — and incur the cost of — a full diagnostic assessment.

Stage One — Initial screening and brief assessment memo

FEE · \$500

Stage One includes:

- Completion of initial intake and background-information forms.
- Validated ADHD screening questionnaires.
- Review of your reported symptoms, history and current areas of difficulty.
- Preliminary consideration of whether ADHD may be an appropriate explanation.
- A brief written memo summarising the screening findings and recommendations.

The memo will clarify whether proceeding to a full diagnostic assessment is recommended. It may also identify other factors that warrant consideration or suggest alternative forms of support.

Stage One is a screening process and does not provide a formal ADHD diagnosis.

You are not required to continue to Stage Two. If you decide not to proceed — or if a full ADHD assessment is not clinically indicated — the process can conclude after you receive your screening memo.

Stage Two — Full diagnostic assessment

ADDITIONAL FEE · \$1,600

If the Stage One findings support further assessment and you choose to continue, Stage Two includes:

- A comprehensive clinical and developmental interview.
- Detailed exploration of your history from childhood to the present.
- Assessment of functioning across education, work, relationships, health, home life and other relevant settings.
- Review of ADHD symptoms and associated executive-functioning difficulties.
- Consideration of sleep, mood, anxiety, stress, trauma, substance use, medical factors and other possible explanations.
- Review of collateral information where available, such as school reports or information from a parent, partner or another person who knows you well.
- Formal diagnostic assessment against DSM-5-TR criteria.
- A feedback consultation to discuss the findings and recommendations.
- A comprehensive written diagnostic report.

TOTAL COST OF THE COMPLETE TWO-STAGE ASSESSMENT

Stage One \$500 · Stage Two \$1,600

\$2,100

03 What should I do to prepare?

Less than you might expect.

You do not need to arrive with your life story indexed or your difficulties neatly organised. In fact, organisation, memory and sequencing are often part of what ADHD makes difficult.

Old school reports, previous assessments, a rough developmental timeline or input from someone who has known you for a long time can be useful if they are readily available. If they are not, please come as you are. We will help you work through the relevant information.

04 Will it feel like a test I can fail?

No. There is nothing to pass or fail, and nothing you need to perform.

The assessment is a structured clinical conversation, not an interrogation. Our approach is strengths-first: we recognise what you do well and the intelligent adaptations you have already developed, alongside the areas in which life may require disproportionate effort.

Many people find the assessment process clarifying, regardless of the eventual diagnostic outcome.

| *“I expected to be caught out. Instead, for the first time, I felt accurately seen.”*

05 What if the answer is “no” or “not quite”?

That is a genuine and valuable outcome — not a failed or wasted assessment.

If ADHD is not the best explanation for your experiences, the assessment may clarify what else is contributing and guide you toward more appropriate support. Sometimes a person has meaningful ADHD-related traits without meeting the full diagnostic criteria. These difficulties can still be understood and addressed.

A careful “no” is worth considerably more than a careless “yes.”

06 What will I receive?

If you complete **Stage One only**, you will receive:

- A brief written summary of the screening findings.
- An indication of whether a full diagnostic assessment is recommended.
- Practical recommendations regarding appropriate next steps.

If you complete **both stages**, you will also receive:

- A clear diagnostic outcome.
- A comprehensive written report that can be shared with your GP or other health professionals.
- An individualised formulation explaining how your particular pattern of strengths and difficulties operates.
- An understanding of where your executive load sits and how it affects daily functioning.
- Practical recommendations, which may include consideration of medication, ADHD-adapted psychological support, executive-functioning strategies, environmental adjustments or further assessment where appropriate.
- A feedback consultation to help translate the findings into a workable plan.

07 How does the Executive Frame™ fit in?

Diagnosis is the beginning, not the destination.

The Executive Frame™ is our clinical framework for turning assessment findings into a more workable life. Support is organised around:

Centre > Clarify > Choose

- **Centre:** establish the foundations for regulation, safety and sustainable functioning.
- **Clarify:** build an accurate understanding of your brain, patterns, needs and environment.
- **Choose:** make deliberate, values-aligned decisions about support, strategies and next steps.

The assessment helps us identify where to begin.

THE PRINCIPLE UNDERNEATH

A diagnosis explains you — it does not add anything to you.

Everything you have achieved, you achieved with this brain. Assessment simply offers a more accurate explanation and a better set of instructions.